



was created and ruled by a great fire-and-metal beast called Ormagöden. After the beast's fall, the world was inherited by a race of super-humans called The Titans who's greatest contribution to the world is Heavy Metal music.

For most part, the game plays like a typical open-world game. However, what sets this game apart from the rest is the intricately crafted architecture and landscape. Strewn across the world map are triggers for the game's main campaign mission and a host of side-mission. Completion of these missions is rewarded with Fire Tributes—a currency of this world, used to purchase upgrades. Providing these upgrades is the Guardian of Metal—a role expertly played by Ozzy Osbourne.

In addition to completing these missions, Fire Tribute can be earned by unlocking points of interest scattered throughout the game world—each with its own, additional unique reward. For example, freeing a fixed number of gagged Dragon Statues will be rewarded with a boost to character attributes like health. Other rewards come in the form of new guitar solos, additional music tracks that can be played on The Deuce's radio, insight into the origin of the world and a panoramic view of the world's many landmarks.

## VULGAR DISPLAY OF POWER

Fire Tributes are exchanged to purchase, among other things, upgrades for your guitar, battleaxe and the hotrod. Most notable of these upgrades are the ones available for your car—on complete upgrade, it transforms The Deuce into one of the best looking cars ever seen in a game. It's not all about looking cool however, as there is some serious fire power available for your machine, along with performance and armor upgrades.



The game has a fair bit of variety when it comes to combat. Combination of guitar and battleaxe can be used to attack your enemies with some devastating combos, most of them stylized after the on-stage antics of Metal bands. Ranged fire power is available by using only the guitar—either in the form of combos or guitar solos.

Guitar solos take on the traditional role of magic spell and works a lot like note matching style of music games like Guitar Hero and Rock Band. Some of these guitar solos are context sensitive, while most of them have unlimited uses. To prevent spamming however, some of these powers have a cool-down timer. Additional combos and weapon upgrades become available as you progress in the main campaign and they can be accessed by visiting Guardian of Metal at one of the several Metal Forges in the game world.

## BRING YOUR DAUGHTER TO THE SLAUGHTER

Apart from the solo exploration missions, the game will throw you into a group battle called Stage Battle. This mode has some elements from the RTS genre and some from squad-based games like Overlord and Pikmin. In a Stage Battle, a concert stage acts as a base of operations and the battle commences with each side setting up their own stage.

The ultimate goal here is to destroy the opposing forces' Stage. To achieve this goal, you'll need to recruit combatents from your Stage—

